



Constitution
of the
M.: W.: Grand Lodge
of
Free and Accepted Masons
of Utah
Revised February 2026

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DECLARATION

Whereas, Each Grand Lodge possesses the inherent power to form a Constitution, as the Fundamental Law of its Masonic actions, and to enact such by-laws, from time to time, as it may deem necessary for its own government, and to make such rules and regulations for the administration of its constituent Lodges as will insure the prosperity thereof and promote the general good of Masonry; and

Whereas, This power is the supreme Masonic power and authority in the State of Utah, and is derived from organized Masonic bodies or constituent Lodges, through their legally constituted representatives, and gives to this Grand Lodge all the attributes of sovereignty and government, legislative, executive, and judicial, limited only by a strict adherence to the ancient usages of Freemasonry, by the provisions of its own Constitution and Regulations; and by the provisions of its Articles of Incorporation;

Therefore, Upon these principles, which have never been disputed, the Grand Lodge of Free and Accepted Masons of Utah does hereby ordain, establish, and promulgate the following Constitution for its future government, and does enact, make and prescribe the following Rules and Regulations for the government of the Lodges under its jurisdiction:

ARTICLE I: TITLE-SEALS

SECTION 1. NAME.

This Grand Lodge shall be known by the name and style of “The Most Worshipful Grand Lodge of Free and Accepted Masons of Utah.”

SECTION 2. SEALS.

It shall have a seal, bearing such device and inscription as has been, or may hereafter be, determined, which shall be affixed to all instruments issued under its authority.

There shall also be a seal known as the “Grand Master’s Seal,” to be used by him on all official instruments he may issue in his capacity as Grand Master. Said seal shall forever bear the device and inscription which may be determined upon by the Grand Lodge.

ARTICLE II: AUTHORITY AND TERRITORIAL JURISDICTION

SECTION 1. SOURCE OF AUTHORITY AND JURISDICTION.

This Grand Lodge is the only source of authority and exercises exclusive jurisdiction in all matters pertaining to Ancient Craft Masonry in the State of Utah.

SECTION 2. TERRITORIAL JURISDICTION.

The territorial jurisdiction of the Grand Lodge of Utah is co-extensive with the geographical boundaries of the State.

SECTION 3. SHARED JURISDICTION.

The Grand Lodge may elect to share such exclusive territorial jurisdiction with one other Grand Lodge by mutual consent, provided each Grand Lodge remains sovereign with sole and undisputed authority over all its members, beholden lodges, their members, and properties deriving authority from them. In addition, all provisions of the

Constitution, Title II, Title III, and the Trial Code of the Grand Lodge, Free and Accepted Masons of Utah, shall apply only to those lodges and members, thereof, which are chartered by said Grand Lodge.

ARTICLE III: COMPOSITION

SECTION 1. MEMBERS.

The Grand Lodge shall consist of a Grand Master (whose address shall be Most Worshipful); a Deputy Grand Master, a Senior Grand Warden, a Junior Grand Warden, a Grand Treasurer, a Grand Secretary (whose several addresses shall be Right Worshipful); a Grand Chaplain, a Grand Orator, a Grand Lecturer, a Grand Marshal, a Senior Grand Deacon, a Junior Grand Deacon, a Senior Grand Steward, a Junior Grand Steward, a Grand Historian, a Grand Tyler, and, at the discretion of the Grand Master-elect, a Grand Chancellor, a Grand Standard-Bearer, a Grand Sword-Bearer (whose several addresses shall be Worshipful), and such other Grand Officers as the Grand Lodge may provide; and also Past Grand Masters, Past Deputy Grand Masters, Past Grand Wardens, Past Grand Treasurers, and Past Grand Secretaries; and Past Masters who have been duly elected and have actually presided in their respective offices in Lodges in this jurisdiction, or in any other jurisdiction recognized as “regular” by this Grand Lodge and with which this Grand Lodge maintains fraternal relations, and who are at the time members of Lodges within this jurisdiction; the Worshipful Masters and Wardens for the time being of the several chartered Lodges under the jurisdiction of this Grand Lodge or their legally appointed proxies; provided, that no Lodge shall be entitled to representation unless its annual dues are paid in full.

SECTION 2. PROXIES.

Whenever the Worshipful Master and Wardens of any Lodge, or either of them, shall be unable to attend the communications of the Grand Lodge, they, or either of them who cannot so attend, may with approval of his Lodge, depute any member of their own Lodge who is of equal or superior rank as a proxy to represent their Lodge at the annual communication of the Grand Lodge, and the proxy so deputed shall be entitled to the same privileges and perform the duties of him or them deputing him. Such representative shall produce a letter of proxy, signed by the officer deputizing him, together with the resolution of his Lodge, under its seal, authorizing the appointment of such proxy. Provided, however, that if such Master or Wardens shall subsequently attend any session of such Grand Lodge, then, and in that case, the proxy so given shall be considered revoked during the attendance of such Master or Wardens.

A Lodge represented at a communication of the Grand Lodge by either its Master or a Warden shall be considered fully represented; provided, that any Lodge in the absence of its Master and both Wardens may be represented by a proxy duly elected by such Lodge at a regular or special meeting called for that purpose, and such proxy shall have all the rights and privileges of the Master or Wardens when present.

SECTION 3. QUALIFICATIONS OF MEMBERS.

Every member of this Grand Lodge must be affiliated with some Lodge in this Grand Jurisdiction, and on demission, suspension, or expulsion of any Grand Lodge member by his Lodge, or by any other authority of Ancient Craft Masonry, his name shall be dropped from the roll of Grand Lodge membership.

SECTION 4. REINSTATEMENT BY GRAND LODGE.

Any member who shall be dropped from the roll of Grand Lodge membership, if by reason of demission from his Lodge, shall be reinstated on producing evidence of affiliation with some Lodge in this Grand Lodge Jurisdiction; and if by reason of suspension, he may be reinstated by producing evidence of restoration by his Lodge.

ARTICLE IV: COMMUNICATIONS

SECTION 1. COMMUNICATIONS.

The Grand Lodge shall hold a regular communication at least once in each year, at such place as may be designated in its by-laws; but special communications may be ordered by the Grand Master (or in his absence from the state, or inability to attend to his duties, by the Deputy Grand Master, or the other presiding officer for the time being) whenever in his opinion the welfare of the Fraternity shall require it, and every such order for a special communication shall state the object thereof, so far as it is proper to be written, and each constituent Lodge under this jurisdiction shall have due notice of such communication, and no business shall be transacted thereat except such as is specified in said order.

ARTICLE V: QUORUM

SECTION 1. QUORUM.

The Grand Lodge shall not be opened, nor shall any business be transacted therein, unless a majority of the chartered Lodges under its jurisdiction be represented, but a less number may meet and adjourn from day-to-day, until the above provided representation shall attend. Provided that at special communications called for ceremonial purposes, the Grand Master, or his duly authorized representative, with a sufficient number of Brethren to fill the stations and places, may at any time, open the Grand Lodge and perform the ceremony for which it was convened; and provided further, that when the communication has been called for the purpose of laying a cornerstone, the Grand Lodge shall be opened on the Entered Apprentice Degree.

ARTICLE VI: ELIGIBILITY

SECTION 1. ELIGIBILITY.

No brother shall be eligible to office in this Grand Lodge who is not at the time of election or appointment a member thereof and a member in good and regular standing of a Chartered Lodge constituent to this Grand Lodge, and no brother shall be eligible to the office of Grand Master or Deputy Grand Master, who is not a Past Master, having been duly elected and having presided over a Lodge under the jurisdiction of this Grand Lodge. Grand Wardens must be Past or acting Masters.

ARTICLE VII: ELECTIONS – APPOINTMENTS – INSTALLATIONS

SECTION 1. ELECTIVE OFFICERS.

At each Annual Communication there shall be elected by ballot a Deputy Grand Master, a Senior Grand Warden, a Junior Grand Warden, a Grand Treasurer, and a Grand Secretary. A majority of all the votes cast shall be necessary to a choice. The Deputy Grand Master will be considered the Grand Master-elect, and will be installed as the Most Worshipful Grand Master at the succeeding Annual Communication. At the succeeding Grand Lodge Communication, should the Deputy Grand Master (Grand Master-elect) be unable, for any reason, to be installed to the office of the Most Worshipful Grand Master, there shall be elected by ballot from the brethren who are constitutionally eligible, a Grand Master, a Deputy Grand Master, a Senior Grand Warden, a Junior Grand Warden, a Grand Treasurer, and a Grand Secretary. A majority of all the votes cast shall be necessary to a choice.

SECTION 2. APPOINTIVE OFFICERS.

All other Grand Officers shall be appointed by the Grand Master-elect, but no Grand Officer shall assume the duties of his office until he shall have been duly installed.

All officers shall hold their offices until their successors are elected or appointed and installed.

SECTION 3. INSTALLATION.

All Grand Officers must be installed in person, and reelection or reappointment to the same office shall not relieve any officer from the necessity of being re-installed.

ARTICLE VIII: VOTES

SECTION 1. VOTING.

Each of the Grand Lodge Officers present and each elective Past Grand Officer, when present at the meeting of the Grand Lodge, shall be entitled to one vote; each Lodge shall be entitled to three votes by its proper officers, or in their absence, their representatives; and Past Masters present and not otherwise entitled to vote shall each be entitled to vote except when voting for officers, in which event Past Masters shall be entitled collectively to a single vote. The voting on all questions shall be by a show of hands, by written ballot, or by yeas or nays, when properly ordered. When a show of hands vote is called for, a member having more than one vote will vote his preference by holding up a voting card, which will designate by number or by color the number of votes he is casting. When the vote is by ballot, the member having more than one vote will be issued the number of ballots entitled by his voting card. If yeas and nays are called for, a member having more than one ballot will so indicate verbally when his name is called.

SECTION 2. TWO VOTES.

If a brother is present as a member of the Grand Lodge by virtue of his past or present official rank and is also a representative in attendance for his Lodge, he may vote in each capacity.

SECTION 3. REPRESENTATIVES OF LODGES.

In case a constituent Lodge has but one representative present, he may cast three votes; if two representatives be present, the highest in rank shall cast two votes, and the lowest, one; if three representatives be present, they shall cast but one vote each.

SECTION 4. AS A UNIT.

On every constitutional amendment and on every other question that may come before the Grand Lodge for decision upon which a vote by Lodges only is lawful, each constituent Lodge shall vote as a unit, by its representative or representatives present, who by a majority vote shall decide on which side of the question the vote of the Lodge shall be cast.

SECTION 5. DECIDING VOTE.

On all questions, excepting those decided by ballot and by Lodges, the presiding officer shall have the casting vote in case of a tie.

SECTION 6. YEAS AND NAYS.

The yeas and nays shall be ordered upon the demand of five representatives. In taking the yeas and nays, the Lodges in their order shall be called first, the Past Masters secondly, the Past Grand Officers thirdly, and the Grand Officers last.

SECTION 7. BLANKS.

In all cases where paper ballots are used in voting, blanks shall not be counted.

SECTION 8. MUST VOTE.

Every member entitled to vote shall, unless excused by the Grand Lodge or Grand Master, vote on all questions coming before the Grand Lodge.

SECTION 9. ELECTIONEERING.

Electioneering in any way for office in Grand Lodge is positively prohibited, and any member guilty of the offense shall be ineligible to office, and if an officer, shall forfeit the office held by him. Visitors electioneering for any candidate for office shall be prohibited visiting the sessions of the Grand Lodge.

ARTICLE IX: VACANCIES

SECTION 1. SUCCESSION.

In case of the death, disability or a change of residence to another jurisdiction of the Grand Master, his place shall be filled in regular succession by the Deputy Grand Master, the Senior Grand Warden, and the Junior Grand Warden; in case of the death, disability or change of residence of all these Grand Officers, the most immediate Past Grand Master present within this jurisdiction and able to act shall be Grand Master.

SECTION 2. VACANCIES.

All vacancies shall be filled by the Grand Master for the time being. The office of Grand Master is never vacant.

ARTICLE X: POWERS AND JURISDICTION

SECTION 1. DISPENSATIONS.

This Grand Lodge may grant dispensations and charters for holding regular Lodges of Free and Accepted Masons in Utah, and in other territory where no Grand Lodge exists, with the right to confer therein the several degrees of Entered Apprentice, Fellow Craft, and Master Mason, and when deemed expedient, and for good cause, may annul, revoke, or amend such dispensation or charter.

SECTION 2. JURISDICTION.

This Grand Lodge has original and exclusive jurisdiction over all subjects of Masonic legislation and administration, appellate and administrative jurisdiction from the decisions of Worshipful Masters, and from the decisions and acts of Lodges; and when expedient, has original jurisdiction over its officers, members, and Worshipful Masters, and its enactments and decisions upon all questions shall be the supreme Masonic law in the State of Utah.

SECTION 3. BOUNDS AND CONTROVERSIES.

This Grand Lodge may assign the limits and fix the location of each lodge under its jurisdiction, and settle all controversies that may arise between different Lodges, and has the final decision and determination of all controversies or grievances which may be brought up by appeal or otherwise.

SECTION 4. LAW FOR LODGES.

It may make and adopt general laws and regulations for the government of the several Lodges under its jurisdiction, and at pleasure may alter, amend, or repeal the same.

SECTION 5. ASSESS AND COLLECT FINES.

It may assess and collect from the several Lodges under its jurisdiction such sums of money annually as may be provided for by law and found necessary for the support and maintenance of the Grand Lodge.

SECTION 6. CHARITY FUND.

It may establish a Charity Fund, and provide for its maintenance by appropriating at each annual communication a sum not to exceed ten per cent of its annual receipts, or by assessing and collecting from each Lodge in the jurisdiction such sums as may be deemed expedient.

SECTION 7. FINANCES.

It may supervise the state and condition of its own finances, and adopt such measures in relation thereto as may be deemed necessary.

SECTION 8. DISCIPLINE.

It may reprimand, suspend, or expel any member from its own body for a violation of the Constitution, By-laws and Regulations of the Grand Lodge, or for any other unmasonic conduct; and shall have power to adjudicate upon all appeals from constituent Lodges.

SECTION 9. GENERAL OVERSIGHT.

This Grand Lodge shall at each communication consider and review the reports and doings of its Grand Officers for the past year, as well as those of the several Lodges under its jurisdiction. And, finally, may do whatsoever may be considered necessary to the well-being and prosperity of Ancient Craft Masonry in the State of Utah.

ARTICLE XI: SOVEREIGNTY

SECTION 1. SOVEREIGNTY.

This Grand Lodge is the only sovereign body over Symbolic Masonry in the State of Utah, and has the exclusive right to establish and maintain Masonic Lodges for conferring the degrees of Entered Apprentice, Fellow Craft, and Master Mason within its jurisdiction.

SECTION 2. LEGITIMATE MASONRY.

This Grand Lodge has the sole right to declare what legitimate Freemasonry is, and any organization, association, parties, or persons professing to have any authority, powers or privileges in Freemasonry, and practicing the same within the geographical boundaries of the State of Utah, which are not recognized by this Grand Lodge, are hereby declared clandestine, and all intercourse with, or recognition of, them by any Lodge constituent to this Grand Lodge, or any member thereof, is hereby declared a Masonic offense and subject to trial as provided for in the Trial Code.

ARTICLE XII: THE GRAND MASTER

SECTION 1. POWERS OF GRAND MASTER.

The Grand Master is invested with all the power and authority and is entitled to all the privileges and prerogatives which attach to his high office by the ancient usages of Freemasonry, subject to limitations of this Constitution and the requirements of Grand Lodge, as expressed by its laws.

The Grand Master shall, during the recess of the Grand Lodge, have the following more defined power and authority:

- First. He may grant dispensations for new Lodges, subject to the provisions of the By-laws of the Grand Lodge.
- Second. He may arrest the charter of any Lodge for good cause, until the next annual communication of the Grand Lodge, informing the Lodge of the cause, and setting forth in his annual message the reasons for such arrest, and such charter so arrested shall not be restored except by the action of the Grand Lodge. He may also suspend the functions of any Lodge, pending investigation.
- Third. He may convene the Grand Lodge at his pleasure, and when for any business affecting the welfare of the Craft shall give due notice, through the Grand Secretary, to the Lodges and members of the time, place, and object of such meeting.
- Fourth. He may authorize any Past or present Grand Officer, or Past or present Master of a Lodge, to convene a Grand Lodge for the following purposes: To lay the cornerstone of a Masonic hall or public edifice, to dedicate and consecrate a Masonic hall, to constitute a new Lodge, and to set a Lodge under dispensation to work.
- Fifth. He may, with the written concurrence of the Deputy Grand Master and Grand Wardens, or any two of them, declare a Grand Lodge appointed office vacant, and appoint and install to fill such vacancy.
- Sixth. He may, for good cause, arrest the Jewel of or remove from office any Worshipful Master or Warden of any Lodge, pending investigation, or until the next Annual Communication of the Grand Lodge.
- Seventh. The Grand Master may, for good and sufficient cause, and with the written concurrence of the Deputy Grand Master, Grand Wardens, or any two of them suspend the membership of any Mason until such time as:
- The Grand Master sees fit to rescind said suspension, or
 - The reasons for said suspension initiate the filing of Masonic charges thereby invoking the procedures outlined in the Grand Lodge Trial Code or,
 - The convening of the next following Grand Lodge Communication at which time said suspension will be rescinded or re-affirmed by action of the Grand Lodge.
- Eighth. He may in person or by Deputy convene any Lodge within the jurisdiction, preside therein, inspect its proceedings and books, and require its conformity to Masonic law and usage.
- Ninth. He may appoint Grand Representatives of this Grand Lodge near other recognized Grand Lodges, receive and accredit Grand Representatives of those recognized Grand Lodges near this Grand Lodge, revoke the commission of any Grand Representative who fails to comply with the by-laws of this Grand Lodge, and request other Grand Masters to do likewise if their Grand Representatives near this Grand Lodge fail to comply with the by-laws.
- Tenth. He may grant such dispensations as may be applied for in accordance with the laws of the Grand Lodge.
- Eleventh. He may render official decisions, which shall be binding only until approved at the next Annual Communication of the Grand Lodge.
- Twelfth. He may exercise such powers as are warranted, and perform such duties as are required of him by the Ancient Regulations or customs of the Craft; provided, always, that he shall have no power to suspend the operation of any law of the Grand Lodge.
- Thirteenth. He may “heal” or re-obligate a Mason irregularly made in a regular Lodge, but healing must take place in a Chartered Lodge duly opened.

Fourteenth. On the first day of each Annual Communication of the Grand Lodge, or as soon thereafter as possible, the Grand Master shall lay before the Grand Lodge his annual address, giving an account of his official acts during recess, the state and condition of Masonry in the jurisdiction, and recommend to the Grand Lodge such measures as he may deem necessary and expedient.

ARTICLE XIII: OTHER GRAND OFFICERS

SECTION 1. OTHER OFFICERS.

The powers and duties of all other officers of the Grand Lodge shall be declared and defined in its by-laws.

ARTICLE XIV: ARRAIGNMENT OF MASTER

SECTION 1. ARRAIGNMENT OF MASTER.

Charges may be preferred against the Master of a Lodge by any three members thereof for abuse of his power, violation of the Constitution or regulations, or for unmasonic conduct of any kind, which charges shall be in writing over their signatures, and shall be presented to the Grand Lodge, if in session, or to the Grand Master during recess, and shall be tried and determined in the manner prescribed by the Trial Code of this Grand Lodge.

ARTICLE XV: AMENDMENTS

SECTION 1. AMENDMENTS.

Any amendment, alteration, or change of this Constitution must be proposed in writing at an Annual Communication of the Grand Lodge, and referred to the Committee on Jurisprudence for its opinion, and if then, by two-thirds of all the members present and voting, the same shall be approved, such amendment, alteration, or change must be submitted to the Grand Lodge at its next Annual Communication, and if then approved by a vote of two-thirds of the Lodges represented therein, the same shall become a part of this Constitution, and take effect within ten days after its adoption.